SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

20 July 2022 · Shift 1

67 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 33 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. After a long and “rigorous” fast the Lord appeared before him.

(A) Sweaty
(B) Exhausting
(C) Oppressive
(D) Lenient

Q.2

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Most workers “resigns” to join new jobs within the same industry.

(A) resigned
(B) was resigning
(C) No improvement required
(D) has resigned

Q.3

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. A tiger’s skull / is similar / to / a lion.

(A) is similar
(B) A tiger’s skull
(C) a lion
(D) to

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. My friend, who is a photographer, is _____ a writer.

(A) also
(B) too
(C) again
(D) and

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The bank was prepared to _____ chance and lend him 40% of the purchase price.

(A) make a
(B) spare a
(C) take a
(D) see a

Q.6

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. People and / there demands / are ever-growing, but / the availability of land is limited.

(A) People and
(B) there demands
(C) the availability of land is limited
(D) are ever-growing, but

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I'm frustrated with the _____ minded view of history this article presents.

(A) small
(B) wide
(C) narrow
(D) bigger

Q.8

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Caffeine is a diuretic that makes you urinate "more often."

(A) No improvement required
(B) more much often
(C) many often
(D) oftenly more

Q.9

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. I always "smell a rat" when John says that he is going out for extra classes.

(A) Suspect trickery or deception
(B) Reveal a secret
(C) Trust completely
(D) Say something stupid

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The Armenian language has many dialects, some of which cannot be _____ by speakers of other dialects.

(A) understood
(B) realised
(C) memorised
(D) completed

Q.11

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Someone who is silent or uncommunicative in speech.

(A) Garrulous
(B) Reserved
(C) Voluble
(D) Imperceptible

Q.12

Select the idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Roy's customers think that the council has "become irrational."

(A) Too much on their plates
(B) A piece of cake
(C) Browned off
(D) Gone bananas

Q.13

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Ebullient

(A) Carefree
(B) Dejected
(C) Buoyant
(D) Roguish

Q.14

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. The family can "none long stay" in their big house.

(A) not stay longest
(B) No improvement required
(C) stay no long
(D) no longer stay

Q.15

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Enraged

(A) Peaceful
(B) Fortunate
(C) Furious
(D) Elated

Q.16

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Foriegn
(B) Secondary
(C) Evince
(D) Portfolio

Q.17

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Flagrant

(A) Favourable
(B) Wonderful
(C) Magnificent
(D) Atrocious

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required.' Many people believe that women make better nurses "because they are" patient and gentle.

(A) because she is
(B) as they would
(C) because they were
(D) No substitution required

Q.19

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Eqiupment
(B) Strengthen
(C) Instrumentle
(D) Reversel

Q.20

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Many countries are not acting / fast enough to controlled / climate change.

(A) climate change
(B) Many countries are not acting
(C) No error
(D) fast enough to controlled

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Elephant Island's name is attributed to (1) _____ its elephant head-like appearance and the sighting of elephant seals (2) _____ Captain George Powell in 1821, one of the (3) _____ sightings. (4) _____, in Russia it is still known under the name (5) _____ by its discoverers in 1821 – Mordvinova Island.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) either
(B) also
(C) both
(D) neither

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Elephant Island's name is attributed to (1) _____ its elephant head-like appearance and the sighting of elephant seals (2) _____ Captain George Powell in 1821, one of the (3) _____ sightings. (4) _____, in Russia it is still known under the name (5) _____ by its discoverers in 1821 – Mordvinova Island.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) through
(B) from
(C) among
(D) by

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Elephant Island's name is attributed to (1) _____ its elephant head-like appearance and the sighting of elephant seals (2) _____ Captain George Powell in 1821, one of the (3) _____ sightings. (4) _____, in Russia it is still known under the name (5) _____ by its discoverers in 1821 – Mordvinova Island.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) earlier
(B) early
(C) most early
(D) earliest

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Elephant Island's name is attributed to (1) _____ its elephant head-like appearance and the sighting of elephant seals (2) _____ Captain George Powell in 1821, one of the (3) _____ sightings. (4) _____, in Russia it is still known under the name (5) _____ by its discoverers in 1821 – Mordvinova Island.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) Thus
(B) However
(C) Thereby
(D) Therefore

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Elephant Island's name is attributed to (1) _____ its elephant head-like appearance and the sighting of elephant seals (2) _____ Captain George Powell in 1821, one of the (3) _____ sightings. (4) _____, in Russia it is still known under the name (5) _____ by its discoverers in 1821 – Mordvinova Island.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) released
(B) sorted
(C) given
(D) looked

General Intelligence and Reasoning 17 questions

Q.3

Three boys T, R and M are sitting in a row facing towards the north (not necessarily in the same order), and three girls F, G and K are sitting in a row facing towards the face of these boys (not necessarily in the same order). F and R are diagonally opposite to each other. K is not at any of the ends. Which of the following pairs of persons facing towards each other is/are definitely correct? I. GR II. KT

(A) Only I
(B) Only II
(C) Both I and II
(D) Neither I nor II

Q.4

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. KSZ : PHC :: TNK : ?

(A) MGN
(B) GNO
(C) GMO
(D) GMN

Q.5

Eight girls A, B, C, D, E, F, G and H are sitting around a circular table facing opposite to the centre (not necessarily in the same order). B is second to the left of D. F is third to the left of B. A is second to the left of F. C is second to the left of A. G is third to the left of E. Three out of the following four options are similar by a certain logic and form a group. Which of the following does NOT belong to that group?

(A) A, C, E
(B) D, B, H
(C) D, H, G
(D) C, E, F

Q.7

In a certain code language, 'GAME' is coded as '78', and 'PNAD' is coded as '105'. How will 'HORN' be coded in that language?

(A) 135
(B) 165
(C) 145
(D) 170

Q.9

In a certain code language, 'HALMST' is written as 'IZMLTS' and 'GEASTR' is written as 'HDBRUQ'. How will 'TRAILS' be written in that language?

(A) UOBHMR
(B) UQBHNR
(C) UQBIMR
(D) UQBHMR

Q.11

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and fourth number is related to third number. 23 : 25 :: 17 : 64 :: 29 : ?

(A) 119
(B) 144
(C) 121
(D) 169

Q.12

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 64, 51, 38, ?, 12, –1

(A) 25
(B) 22
(C) 27
(D) 24

Q.13

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. Some games are lands. II. Some toys are games. Conclusions: I. Some toys are not lands. II. Some lands are games.

(A) Only conclusion I follows
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Both conclusions I and II follow

Q.14

In a certain code language, 'WORD' is written as 'CUXJ' and 'MOKE' is written as ‘SUQK’. How will 'IDEA' be written in that language?

(A) OJKG
(B) OJLG
(C) OJLH
(D) OJMG

Q.15

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 13, 51, 205, 819, 3277, ?

(A) 13109
(B) 13107
(C) 13108
(D) 13106

Q.16

Select the option in which the two numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers in the given number-pair. 64 : 10 :: ?

(A) 84 : 12
(B) 54 : 12
(C) 32 : 1
(D) 42 : 8

Q.18

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. GROW, FSNX, ETMY, ?, CVKA

(A) DULX
(B) DVLA
(C) DVLZ
(D) DULZ

Q.19

After interchanging which two numbers will the value of the given expression be '173'? 52 – 36 + 141 × 63 ÷ 47

(A) 141 and 52
(B) 47 and 63
(C) 52 and 36
(D) 63 and 141

Q.21

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. FNNC: CKKZ:: ADRS: XAOP:: BNNL: ?

(A) ZKKI
(B) ZKKJ
(C) YKKI
(D) YKKJ

Q.22

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. PRO : NOL :: HEL : ?

(A) FIB
(B) FCJ
(C) FJC
(D) FBI

Q.24

In a certain code language, 'BASEBALL' is written as '45' and 'FEEDBACK' is written as '73'. How will 'PRACTICE' be written in that language?

(A) 27
(B) 37
(C) 57
(D) 47

Q.25

After interchanging the given two signs and two numbers, what will be the value of the given expression? 15 and 3; + and ÷; 6 ÷ 3 + 5 × 15 – 9 = ?

(A) 6
(B) 15
(C) 12
(D) 8

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose International airport is situated in _____.

(A) Kolkata
(B) Mumbai
(C) Delhi
(D) Chennai

Q.2
The President of India can nominate maximum _____ members of the Anglo-Indian community to the House of the People, if in his opinion it is not adequately represented.

(A) six
(B) three
(C) four
(D) two

Q.3
'An Unsuitable Boy' is the autobiography of _____.

(A) Karan Johar
(B) Akshay Kumar
(C) Anurag Kashyap
(D) Salman Khan

Q.4
Minati Mishra was associated with which classical dance of India?

(A) Kathak
(B) Kuchipudi
(C) Odissi
(D) Manipuri

Q.5
Which of the following terms is NOT associated with Tennis?

(A) Service break
(B) Goal
(C) Set
(D) Volley

Q.6
Which water body is present to the south of India?

(A) Pacific Ocean
(B) Arabian Sea
(C) Bay of Bengal
(D) Indian Ocean

Q.7
On the basis of age, the population of a nation is generally grouped into _____ broad categories.

(A) Four
(B) Five
(C) Three
(D) Two

Q.8
Bihu is the folk dance form of which Indian state?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Assam
(C) Karnataka
(D) Bihar

Q.9
Who among the following founded Arya Samaj in 1875?

(A) Swami Dayanand Saraswati
(B) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar
(C) Raja Ram Mohan Roy
(D) Swami Vivekanand

Q.10
Which Indian wrestler won a silver medal in Tokyo Olympics 2020?

(A) Virat Kohli
(B) Vijender Singh
(C) Ravi Dahiya
(D) Yogeshwar Dutt

Q.11
The aviation sector was inaugurated in India in the year _____ with the establishment of Tata Airlines.

(A) 1925
(B) 1932
(C) 1929
(D) 1935

Q.12

Which of the following statements is correct? I. Gautama Buddha belonged to a small gana known as the Sakya gana and was a Kshatriya. II. Gautama Buddha passed away at Kusinara.

(A) Only I
(B) Neither I nor II
(C) Only II
(D) Both I and II

Q.13

The core of the Great Himalayas is composed of _____.

(A) Slate
(B) Granite
(C) Sandstone
(D) Limestone

Q.14

Which ministry launched the Krishi Udan 2.0 scheme to facilitate the movement of agricultural produce?

(A) Ministry of Civil Aviation
(B) Ministry of Rural Development
(C) Ministry of Minority Affairs
(D) Ministry of Labour and Employment

Q.15

Who has been reappointed as the Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) in October 2021?

(A) T V Somanthan
(B) Urjit Patel
(C) Shaktikanta Das
(D) D Subbarao

Q.16

Who among the following won the award for Best Music Direction in Feature Films (Songs) at the 67th National Film Awards?

(A) D Immam
(B) Pritam
(C) AR Rahman
(D) Ilaiyaraaja

Q.17

Bhagwati Committee (1973) presented a report on _____.

(A) unemployment
(B) poverty
(C) population growth
(D) commerce

Q.18

Richard Wellesley was the Governor – General of India from _____.

(A) 1806 – 1810
(B) 1811 – 1816
(C) 1817 – 1822
(D) 1798 – 1805

Q.19

The feature of Directive Principles of State Policy in the Indian Constitution is borrowed from the Constitution of _____.

(A) France
(B) Canada
(C) Australia
(D) Ireland

Q.20

Aqua regia is a freshly prepared mixture of concentrated hydrochloric acid and concentrated nitric acid in the ratio of _____ by volume.

(A) 3 : 1
(B) 2 : 1
(C) 6 : 1
(D) 4 : 1

Q.21

Qutbuddin Aybak ruled over Delhi from _____.

(A) 1266 to 1287
(B) 1236 to 1240
(C) 1206 to 1210
(D) 1210 to 1236

Q.22

Madan Mohan temple is a centrally protected monument. It is situated in which state of India?

(A) Himachal Pradesh
(B) Uttarakhand
(C) Uttar Pradesh
(D) Karnataka

Q.23

Typhoid fever is caused by _____.

(A) viruses
(B) protozoa
(C) bacteria
(D) fungi

Q.24

Tooth decay starts when the pH of the mouth is lower than _____.

(A) 5.5
(B) 7.5
(C) 9.5
(D) 10.5

Q.25

'Maru Mahotsav' also known as desert festival is celebrated in _____.

(A) Jaipur
(B) Leh
(C) Jaisalmer
(D) Srinagar

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**
Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(A)**	

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (D) Lenient

'Rigorous' means strict or severe, so its opposite is 'lenient', mild and tolerant. 'Exhausting' and 'oppressive' lean the same way as 'rigorous'.

Q.2 · Answer (A) resigned

The plural subject 'workers' needs a plural verb, and of the options only the simple past 'resigned' agrees with it: 'Most workers resigned to join new jobs'. 'Was resigning' and 'has resigned' are singular forms.

Q.3 · Answer (C) a lion

Like must be compared with like: a tiger's skull is similar to a lion's skull, so the last part should read 'that of a lion' (or 'a lion's').

Q.4 · Answer (A) also

'Also' stands after the verb 'is' and before the words it adds: 'is also a writer'. 'Too' would go at the end of the sentence.

Q.5 · Answer (C) take a

To 'take a chance' is to accept a risk in the hope of success: the bank was willing to risk lending him the money.

Q.6 · Answer (B) there demands

'There' is an adverb of place; the possessive 'their' is needed: 'People and their demands are ever-growing'.

Q.7 · Answer (C) narrow

SSC's key gives 'narrow': a 'narrow-minded' view is one that will not consider other ideas or perspectives, the usual complaint about a one-sided account of history. 'Small-minded' is close in sense but stresses pettiness, and 'wide' and 'bigger' would not be a complaint.

Q.8 · Answer (A) No improvement required

The sentence is correct: 'more often' is the comparative of the adverb 'often'. 'Oftenly' is not a word, and 'many often' and 'more much often' are ungrammatical.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Suspect trickery or deception

To 'smell a rat' is to suspect that something is wrong or that someone is being deceitful.

Q.10 · Answer (A) understood

Dialects that have drifted far apart may not be 'understood' by speakers of other dialects; the sentence is about whether they can follow one another.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Reserved

A 'reserved' person says little and is slow to show feelings or opinions. 'Garrulous' and 'voluble' mean the opposite, talkative, and 'imperceptible' means too slight to be noticed.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Gone bananas

To 'go bananas' is to become crazy or irrational: 'the council has gone bananas'. 'Browned off' means fed up, 'a piece of cake' something easy and 'too much on their plates' too much to deal with.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Dejected

'Ebullient' means cheerful and full of energy, so its opposite is 'dejected', sad and low in spirits. 'Buoyant' and 'carefree' are close to it in meaning.

Q.14 · Answer (D) no longer stay

'No longer' means not any more, and it stands between the modal and the main verb: 'The family can no longer stay in their big house.'

Q.15 · Answer (C) Furious
'Enraged' means very angry: 'furious'. 'Peaceful' and 'elated' are far from it, and 'fortunate' is unrelated.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Foriegn
The correct spelling is 'foreign', with the 'e' before the 'i'.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Atrocious
'Flagrant' describes wrongdoing that is shockingly obvious and offensive, as in a flagrant violation: 'atrocious', very wicked or bad. The other three are words of praise.

Q.18 · Answer (D) No substitution required
The sentence is correct: the plural 'women' takes 'they are', and the present tense suits a belief people hold. 'She is' does not agree with 'women', and 'were' and 'would' shift the tense for no reason.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Strengthen
'Strengthen' is spelt correctly. The others should be 'equipment', 'instrumental' and 'reversal'.

Q.20 · Answer (D) fast enough to controlled
After 'to' the infinitive takes the base form of the verb: 'fast enough to control climate change'.

Q.21 · Answer (C) both
'Both ... and' joins the two reasons for the name: the island's elephant-head shape and the sighting of elephant seals.

Q.22 · Answer (D) by
The seals were sighted 'by' Captain George Powell: 'by' names the person who did the action.

Q.23 · Answer (D) earliest
'One of the' is followed by a superlative: 'one of the earliest sightings'.

Q.24 · Answer (B) However
'However' introduces a contrast: whatever the reasons for the English name, in Russia the island goes by another one.

Q.25 · Answer (C) given
A name is 'given' by the people who name a place: 'the name given by its discoverers in 1821'.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.3 · Answer (A) Only I
K is not at an end, so K sits in the middle of the girls' row and F and G take the ends. R is diagonally opposite F, so R sits at the other end of the boys' row, facing G: GR is definite. K faces the middle boy, who may be T or M, so KT is not definite.

Q.4 · Answer (D) GMN
The first two letters become their opposite letters (A↔Z, B↔Y and so on) and the third moves 3 places on: K → P, S → H, Z → C. So T → G, N → M and K → N: GMN.

Q.5 · Answer (C) D, H, G
Facing outwards, the girls sit in this order going round to the left: D, C, B, E, H, F, G, A. In A, C, E; D, B, H; and C, E, F each girl sits second to the left of the one before, but in D, H, G, H is fourth to the left of D.

Q.7 · Answer (B) 165
Each code is three times the sum of the letters' places in the alphabet: GAME = 7 + 1 + 13 + 5 = 26 and 26 × 3 = 78; PNAD = 35 and 35 × 3 = 105. HORN = 8 + 15 + 18 + 14 = 55, and 55 × 3 = 165.

Q.9 · Answer (D) UQBHMR
The letters move +1 and −1 in turn: H → I, A → Z, L → M, M → L, S → T, T → S. So TRAILS → UQBHMR.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 121
Each second number is the square of the digit sum of the first: $(2 + 3)^2 = 25$ and $(1 + 7)^2 = 64$. So $(2 + 9)^2 = 121$.

Q.12 · Answer (A) 25
Each term is 13 less than the one before: 38 – 13 = 25, and 25 – 13 = 12.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Only conclusion II follows
'Some games are lands' converts to 'Some lands are games', so II follows. Nothing in the statements decides whether any toys lie outside the lands, so I does not follow.

Q.14 · Answer (A) OJKG
Each letter moves 6 places on: W → C, O → U, R → X, D → J and M → S, O → U, K → Q, E → K. So IDEA → OJKG.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 13107
Each term is 4 times the one before, minus and plus 1 in turn: 13 × 4 – 1 = 51, 51 × 4 + 1 = 205, 205 × 4 – 1 = 819, 819 × 4 + 1 = 3277, then 3277 × 4 – 1 = 13107.

Q.16 · Answer (A) 84 : 12
The second number is the sum of the digits of the first: 6 + 4 = 10. Likewise 8 + 4 = 12; the digit sums of 54, 32 and 42 are 9, 5 and 6.

Q.18 · Answer (D) DULZ
The first letters move back one (G, F, E, D, C), the second on one (R, S, T, U, V), the third back one (O, N, M, L, K) and the fourth on one (W, X, Y, Z, A): DULZ.

Q.19 · Answer (C) 52 and 36
After interchanging 52 and 36: 36 – 52 + 141 × 63 ÷ 47 = –16 + 8883 ÷ 47 = –16 + 189 = 173.

Q.21 · Answer (C) YKKI
Each letter moves 3 places back: F → C, N → K, C → Z and A → X, D → A, R → O, S → P. So BNNL → YKKI.

Q.22 · Answer (D) FBI
The letters move back 2, 3 and 3 places: P → N, R → O, O → L. So H → F, E → B, L → I: FBI.

Q.24 · Answer (C) 57
The code is the sum of the letters' places in the alphabet, written backwards: BASEBALL = 2 + 1 + 19 + 5 + 2 + 1 + 12 + 12 = 54 → 45 and FEEDBACK = 37 → 73. PRACTICE = 16 + 18 + 1 + 3 + 20 + 9 + 3 + 5 = 75 → 57.

Q.25 · Answer (A) 6
After interchanging: 6 + 15 ÷ 5 × 3 – 9 = 6 + 3 × 3 – 9 = 6 + 9 – 9 = 6.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Kolkata
Kolkata's airport at Dum Dum is named Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose International Airport.

Q.2 · Answer (D) two
SSC's key gives two, the number in Article 331, under which the President could nominate up to two Anglo-Indian members to the Lok Sabha. The 104th Amendment (2019) did not extend this provision, so it ended on 25 January 2020 and no longer operated when the exam was held in July 2022.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Karan Johar
'An Unsuitable Boy' (2017) is the autobiography of the film-maker Karan Johar.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Odissi
Minati Mishra was an Odissi dancer who trained under Kelucharan Mohapatra and received the Padma Shri in 2012.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Goal
A service break, a set and a volley are all tennis terms; goals are scored in games such as football and hockey, not in tennis.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Indian Ocean
The Indian Ocean lies to the south of India; the Arabian Sea is to the south-west and the Bay of Bengal to the south-east.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Three
NCERT groups a nation's population by age into three broad categories: children (generally below 15 years), working age (15-59 years) and aged (above 59 years).

Q.8 · Answer (B) Assam
Bihu, danced above all at Rongali (Bohag) Bihu in April, is the folk dance of Assam.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Swami Dayanand Saraswati
Swami Dayanand Saraswati founded the Arya Samaj in Bombay in 1875, calling for a return to the Vedas.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Ravi Dahiya
Ravi Kumar Dahiya won silver in the men's freestyle 57 kg wrestling at the Tokyo 2020 Olympics. Virat Kohli is a cricketer, Vijender Singh a boxer, and Yogeshwar Dutt won a wrestling bronze in 2012.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 1932
J R D Tata founded Tata Air Services, later Tata Airlines and then Air India, in 1932; its first flight carried mail from Karachi to Bombay on 15 October 1932.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Both I and II
Both are true: the Buddha was born into the Sakya gana, a small republic, and was a Kshatriya, and he passed away at Kusinara (Kushinagar).

Q.13 · Answer (B) Granite
The Great (Inner) Himalaya, or Himadri, the highest and most continuous range, has a core of granite.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Ministry of Civil Aviation
The Ministry of Civil Aviation launched Krishi UDAN 2.0 on 27 October 2021, waiving airport charges to help carry farm produce by air, especially from the north-east, hilly and tribal regions.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Shaktikanta Das
In October 2021 the government reappointed Shaktikanta Das, Governor since December 2018, for a further three years from 10 December 2021.

Q.16 · Answer (A) D Immam
D. Imman (printed 'D Immam' in the options) won Best Music Direction (Songs) at the 67th National Film Awards, for the Tamil film 'Viswasam'.

Q.17 · Answer (A) unemployment
The Bhagwati Committee was the government's Committee on Unemployment; its 1973 report assessed unemployment and recommended rural works such as roads, housing, electrification and minor irrigation.

Q.18 · Answer (D) 1798 – 1805
Richard Wellesley (Lord Mornington) was Governor-General from 1798 to 1805, when he spread British control through the Subsidiary Alliance.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Ireland
The Directive Principles of State Policy (Part IV) were modelled on the Irish Constitution, as was the method of electing the President.

Q.20 · Answer (A) 3 : 1
Aqua regia is three parts concentrated hydrochloric acid to one part concentrated nitric acid by volume; it can dissolve gold and platinum.

Q.21 · Answer (C) 1206 to 1210
Qutbuddin Aibak, founder of the Slave (Mamluk) dynasty, ruled Delhi from 1206 until his death in 1210.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Uttar Pradesh
The Madan Mohan temple at Vrindavan, in Mathura district of Uttar Pradesh, is a monument of national importance protected by the Archaeological Survey of India.

Q.23 · Answer (C) bacteria
Typhoid fever is caused by the bacterium Salmonella Typhi, spread through contaminated food and water.

Q.24 · Answer (A) 5.5
Bacteria in the mouth make acids from sugars, and tooth enamel starts to corrode when the pH of the mouth falls below 5.5.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Jaisalmer
Maru Mahotsav, the Desert Festival, is held every year at Jaisalmer in the Thar Desert of Rajasthan.

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